Julian Heide

Postdoctoral Research Fellow
Max Planck Institute for Political and Social Science
Department Inequality, Transformation, and Conflict
Hermann-Föge-Weg 11, D-37073 Göttingen

✉ julian.heide@ips.mpg.de
ORCiD: 0009-0005-9268-0887

Research Interests

Social Change and Post-Socialist Transformations, Media and Attitude Formation, Climate Change, Mixed Methods

Academic Positions

since 04/2026	**Postdoctoral Research Fellow**, Max Planck Institute for Political and Social Science
2022-2026	**Ph.D. Researcher,** Department of Social Sciences, Humboldt University Berlin
03/2025-06/2025	**Visiting Researcher** at European University Institute (EUI) Florence, Social and Political Science Department
2022-2026	**Affiliated Researcher at SCRIPTS** Cluster of Excellence, *Contestations of the Liberal Script*, Free University Berlin
2018-2021	**Research Assistant** Department of Social Sciences, Research Unit Macrosociology, Lead: Prof. Dr. Steffen Mau, Humboldt University Berlin

Education

2022-2026	**Ph.D. (Dr. phil.) Humboldt-University Berlin** Dissertation Title: *Mediated Contention. How the Media Shapes Trigger Points and Polarization in Germany.* Committee: Prof. Dr. Steffen Mau, Prof. Dr. Katharina Zimmermann, Prof. Dr. Hanna Schwander Grade: *summa cum laude*
2019-2021	**Master of Arts** in Social Sciences, Humboldt University Berlin Thesis title: *Three Arenas of Social Inequality: A Poverty Perspective on Attitudes.* • **Best Thesis Award** of the German Sociological Association (DGS) in 2022
2015-2019	**Bachelor of Arts** in Social Sciences, Humboldt University Berlin Thesis title: *Housing and Welfare. Socio-political Preferences of Home Owners and Tenants in Germany*.
2018	**Visiting Student** at University of Haifa (Israel)

Publications

Peer-Reviewed Journals

Dietrich, Jonas, Eva Maria Gajek, **Julian Heide**, and Emma Ischinsky (2026, forthcoming). Making Wealth Count. The Public Life of Wealth Statistics in Postwar and Contemporary Germany. *Historical Social Research.*

Thomas Lux and **Julian Heide** (2026): Generation Reunification, Generation Covid? – Visualizing Formative Events in Germany. *Socius*, *doi*.

Mau, Steffen, Thomas Lux and **Julian Heide** (2026): The Long Shadow of the GDR? On the Relationship between former Proximity to the System and Current Political Orientations of East Germans. *Zeitschrift für Soziologie*, *doi*.

Heide, Julian (2025): What Triggers the Media? Emotions and Arguments in German Press Op-Eds. *Zeitschrift für Soziologie*, *doi*.

Heide, Julian (2025): Polarizing Social Figures? Climate Activists in German Media and Popular Discourse. *European Societies*, *doi*.

Mau, Steffen, Thomas Lux and **Julian Heide** (2024): East and West Germans forever? Perceptions of Differences and Conflicts between East and West Germans. In *Kölner Zeitschrift für Soziologie und Sozialpsychologie*, *doi*.

Heide, Julian (2023): Test Case Poverty. On the Relationship between Inequality Attitudes and Social Position. In *Kölner Zeitschrift für Soziologie und Sozialpsychologie, doi*.

Heide, Julian (2021): Home Ownership, Socio-political Attitudes and Region. A Study on Socio-Political Preferences among Homeowners and Tenants in Germany. In *Zeitschrift für Sozialreform* 67(2), pp.153–182, *doi*.

Other Publications

Heide, Julian (2025): Review of Armin Nassehi's book "Kritik der großen Geste: Anders über gesellschaftliche Transformation nachdenken". *Soziologische Revue*. *Link*

Clemens, Simon; Lorena Drakula and **Julian Heide** (2024): U.S. vs. Them. How Populism and Polarization Challenge the Liberal Order. *SCRIPTS Working Paper* No. 49, Berlin: Cluster of Excellence 2055 Contestations of the Liberal Script (SCRIPTS). *Link*

Heide, Julian; Steffen Mau and Thomas Lux (2023): Ost-West-Unterschiede in den Köpfen: Alterität, Konflikt, Anerkennung und Förderung. In Böick, Marcus et al. (eds.) *Jahrbuch Deutsche Einheit*. *Link*

Heide, Julian (2023): Polarisierung von den Rändern denken. Was die Armutsforschung zur Analyse gesellschaftspolitischer Spaltungen beitragen kann. In *SOZIOLOGIE* 1/23, pp. 91-100. *Link*

Teaching

Fall 2025/26	Seminar: Social structure, social inequality and demography (including supervision of term papers), Humboldt University Berlin
Fall 2024/25	Seminar: Social structure, social inequality and demography (including supervision of term papers), Humboldt University Berlin

Spring 2024	Seminar: Social structure and diversity (including supervision of term papers), Humboldt University Berlin

Public Outreach & Media Coverage

Citizen Dialogue of the Academy of Sciences, Pasewalk 2025

German Media

Größerer Demokratieverdruss bei Anhängern des DDR-Regimes? **Deutschlandfunk** 06.02.2025. *Link*

Ist der Osten nur eine Erfindung des Ostens? **Frankfurter Allgemeine Zeitung** 18.05.2024. *Link*

Aufgelesen. Zeitschriftenschau im April 2024. **Soziopolis** 25.04.2024. *Link*

Armut macht migrationskritisch. **Frankfurter Allgemeine Zeitung** 30.06.2023. *Link*

Conferences and Workshop Presentations

2026	**German Sociological Association** (DGS)
	Workshop *Social Risks in Times of Climate Change: Inequalities and Attitudes,* University of Hamburg
2025	**German Sociological Association** (DGS)
	Colloquium Analytical Sociology, EUI Florence
	Spring School *Perceptions of Wealth (Inequality)*, University of Bamberg
	Workshop *Deutschlandmonitor*, University of Jena
2024	**German Political Science Association** (DVPW)
	PhD Fall Workshop 2024, The Institute of Economic and Social Research (WSI) of the Hans-Böckler-Foundation
	Workshop *Trigger Points: Impulses for the Political Communication Research*, Weizenbaum Institute, Berlin
	Workshop *Computational Social Sciences: Bridging Data and Methods with Theory and Application*, Bielefeld University
	Workshop *Between Legitimization and Implementation of Socio-Ecological Transformation Policies in Europe,* Villa Vigoni, Lake Como, Italy
2023	Fall Academy on Perceptions of Inequality II, Cluster of Excellence Politics of Inequality, Constance
	Workshop *Inequalities in East and West Germany – Persistence or Change?* Section Social Inequality of German Sociological Association (DGS), with Steffen Mau
	COMPTEXT, University of Strathclyde, Glasgow, UK
2022	**German Sociological Association** (DGS)
2019	Summer School *Culture of Totalitarian Society and Memory Studies Cases*, Higher School of Economics, Perm, Russia
2016	Summer School *Ethnopolitical developments in times of globalization: State, region and local communities in the post-Soviet space,* University of Southern Ural, Chelyabinsk, Russia

Service to the Profession

Reviewer for Kölner Zeitschrift für Soziologie und Sozialpsychologie, Berliner Journal für Soziologie and Soziale Welt

Co-organization of a session at the convention of the German Sociological Association 2025 & 2026

Representative of the "Mittelbau" at Humboldt University Berlin, Department of Social Sciences

Member of the Ethics Committee at Max-Planck-Institute for Political and Social Science

Memberships

German Sociological Association (DGS)
Section Social Inequality and Social Structure Analysis of the German Sociological Association

Skills

Languages	**German**: first language **English**: proficient **Russian**: proficient
Software	STATA, RStudio, MAXQDA